

## **Resources and Credits - CSCE 4220**

### **Credits:**

Original Video Game Music

By Johnathan Xu

<https://soundcloud.com/jonathan-xu-795831480>

Kenney Asset Pack - All in One

By Kenney

<https://kenney.nl/>

### **Resources:**

Blueprint for Beginners in Unreal Engine 5

By Gorka Games

[https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=tCJ3174CssY&t=80s&ab\\_channel=GorkaGames](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=tCJ3174CssY&t=80s&ab_channel=GorkaGames)

Endless Runner v4.7 Tutorial Series [Playlist]

By Unreal Engine

[https://www.youtube.com/playlist?list=PLZlv\\_N0\\_O1gbY4FN8pZuEPVC9PzQThNn1](https://www.youtube.com/playlist?list=PLZlv_N0_O1gbY4FN8pZuEPVC9PzQThNn1)

Unreal Engine 5.1 Endless Runner Tutorial - Score & High Score

By Shiva's Gaming Zone

[https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RH5xE8a20bY&ab\\_channel=Shiva%27sGamingZone](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RH5xE8a20bY&ab_channel=Shiva%27sGamingZone)

“Coin Magnet Power Up” - Unreal Engine 5 Tutorial

By JemGames

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HKzQZNWTu4w&list=PLCiHxNy70he0-Y9Mcs-0jnx8kSdHfL7O3&index=27>

“How To Create A Main Menu” Tutorial

By Unreal University

[https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=kumZj\\_mov58&ab\\_channel=UnrealUniversity](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=kumZj_mov58&ab_channel=UnrealUniversity)

“Solving Unreal Engine 5 SDK Not Setup Error”

By EZ Unreal

[https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=JHta1LaaUws&t=9s&ab\\_channel=EZUnreal](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=JHta1LaaUws&t=9s&ab_channel=EZUnreal)

“How to add ragdoll physics in Unreal Engine 5”

By Matt Aspland

[https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HewLoAfsAeY&ab\\_channel=MattAspland](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HewLoAfsAeY&ab_channel=MattAspland)

Unreal Engine Forums: “Currency Kept Between Levels”

<https://forums.unrealengine.com/t/currency-kept-between-levels/1702120>

Unreal Engine Forums: “Music looping to specific point”

<https://forums.unrealengine.com/t/music-looping-to-specific-point/399357>

Unreal Engine Forums: ““Set Actor Rotation’ doesn’t work”

<https://forums.unrealengine.com/t/music-looping-to-specific-point/399357>

## **Collaborating with a Composer: A Developer's Process**

I first discovered Johnathan Xu's music reel on YouTube. Instantly drawn to his sound, I reached out to him via email to see if he'd be interested in composing original music for my game. He agreed, and from there, he created two original tracks: a main menu theme and the in-game background music. Here's a breakdown of how that collaboration unfolded:

### **1. Identifying Where Music Is Needed**

The first step is deciding where in your game music will have the most impact. As the developer, prioritize the areas that benefit most from audio—like the main menu, gameplay scenes, or cutscenes. Focus on what matters most first to help the composer concentrate their efforts effectively.

### **2. Communicating Style and Tone**

Once you and the composer agree on which tracks to start with, it's time to convey your vision for the music. This can be challenging—describing a sound or feeling in words isn't easy.

To help bridge that gap, provide reference materials. Share example tracks, gameplay footage, or anything else that captures the tone you're aiming for. Descriptive language paired with concrete examples will give the composer a strong foundation to work from.

### **3. Reviewing Work-in-Progress**

Throughout the process, the composer may send periodic updates. These drafts aren't final, but they offer a snapshot of the direction the music is heading. Listen closely, provide constructive feedback, and make sure the tone aligns with your vision for the game.

### **4. Final Touches and Integration**

Once the track is complete, the final step is fitting it seamlessly into your game. This might include looping the music, adjusting its length, or minor tweaks to timing. Avoid making major revisions at this stage—refinements should be subtle and purpose-driven.